WRENFORD BOROUGH COUNCIL

Statement Guide: Previous Reports

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1. What this guide covers

This guide covers previous reports: earlier reports and repairs at the same place - a pothole patched before and opened up again, a gully cleared and blocked again, a hedge cut back and grown out again, a lamp repaired and failed again. It appears in resident descriptions, call notes and the notes of an earlier inspection.

The guide is used by the Street Care Coordinator or Highways Inspector who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Highways Inspector who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the report and its defect type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a measurement sentence whose figure differs from the report's or gives a figure the report left blank, as the Report Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- an earlier report of the same defect
- a repair that has broken up, sunk or failed
- a gully cleared or a hedge cut back before
- a lamp repaired before
- a mark an inspector left at the defect

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Find the report's count of previous reports at the location.

2 Read each sentence of this kind for earlier reports and repairs.

3 Note a repair that did not last.

4 Note an earlier report the count does not show.

5 Note a location that may need a permanent repair rather than another patch.

4. Requirements it bears on

Previous reports bear on no requirement: the count of previous reports on the report feeds the repeat likelihood, and the requirements still decide which decisions are open.

5. When the statement and the report disagree

When a statement describes more earlier reports than the report's count, the reviewer notes it for the Highways Inspector and keeps the report's count.

6. What to ask the reporter for

Ask the reporter how the earlier report was made, so that it can be found, and what was done at the defect.

7. Telling it apart

An earlier report or repair at the same place is a previous report; who the reporter is and why they are writing is background, which no guide covers. "This was reported before and patched" is a previous report; "I have reported other problems before" is background.